Chinaza Joel Onyekwere

Software Engineer · AI Product Builder · Graphic Designer

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Professional Summary

Software Engineering graduate (B.Tech, Second Class Upper, FUTO, April 2026) and self-taught graphic designer since 2018 who learns best by building real things. Over the past year I have built and shipped SmokeScreen, a real-time AI character tool for streamers, content creators and gamers, which has grown to a community of 20,000+ users. Along the way I have learned hands-on about full-stack development, payments, AI integrations, security and working with a small remote team, and made plenty of mistakes worth learning from. I am still early in my career and eager to grow: I am looking for opportunities to work alongside, and learn from, experienced engineers, product people and founders, and to contribute wherever I can be useful.

Experience

Founder · Software Engineer & Product Builder, JayTech Elite Firm — Lagos, Nigeria

2025 – Present · A small studio I started to help early-stage businesses with design, websites and branding, now focused on building AI products. SmokeScreen and VoiceDrift were built here.

SmokeScreen (launched April 2026) (smokescreenapp.com)

- Built SmokeScreen step by step, from a single-file HTML prototype to a desktop app and then a full web platform, so creators can go live as any character from a normal webcam with no motion-capture rig. It has grown to 20,000+ users, and their feedback has been my best teacher.
- Learned payments in practice by integrating Flutterwave, Paystack, Squad and crypto, and by working through a payment-processor compliance review.
- Found and fixed a bug that was silently skipping creator referral commissions by moving the logic into an atomic Postgres function, a lesson in data integrity I will not forget.
- Wrote the Terms of Service and a Privacy Policy aligned with the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023, learning the basics of product compliance.

- Planning the V2 architecture with the team: one shared core serving web, desktop and Android apps, with each AI provider behind a swappable adapter.
- Kept the service running when our original AI vendor account was disabled by migrating to a new provider; now exploring self-hosted GPU models on RunPod.
- Simplified the product for first-time users (about 70% are new to AI tools) with guided onboarding, presets and plain-language copy.
- Tried different growth ideas, including in-person setup agents in 7 Nigerian cities, TikTok ads and creator partnerships, and learned what works and what does not.

Teamwork & collaboration

- Work alongside a small remote team of developers, a brand strategist and support staff across Nigeria and Pakistan, learning how to hire well, communicate clearly and give useful feedback.
- Use AI-assisted development (Claude Code) to review code and ship fixes together with the team.

Client work

- Built a property listings website with search, filters and an admin panel for Chuks Real Estate, a Lagos client (Node.js, Express, SQLite).
- Exploring a growth-support offer (creator partnerships, referral systems, AI automation) with a travel agency.

Graphic Designer, Joe Elz Graphix — Freelance

October 2018 – Present

- Started my own design brand and delivered fliers, posters, mixtape covers, 3D logos, web designs and digital paintings for restaurants, DJs, student unions and brands, and produced photo manipulations such as dispersion composites, using Adobe Photoshop and CorelDRAW; produced documents and presentations in Microsoft Office.
- Still design SmokeScreen's flyers, creator posters and email templates myself.

Key Projects

SmokeScreen AI Support Agent — Node.js, Express, Telegram Business API, Supabase, Railway

- AI agent that replies inside the real Telegram Business support account, grounded in a knowledge base built from real support chats and styled to match the owner's voice.

- Automated follow-ups, owner alerts, human-takeover pause, an owner-only /teach command, and read-only account and payment lookups through least-privilege Postgres roles; runs 24/7 against a 20,000+ user production database.

VoiceDrift — TypeScript, Express, Prisma, Next.js, BullMQ, Cloudflare R2

- Production AI voice cloning and text-to-speech platform using Fish Audio and ElevenLabs behind an adapter interface, with Whisper voice notes, credits, and Flutterwave and Paystack webhooks; API on Railway, frontend on Vercel.

SmokeScreen Analytics Dashboard — Next.js, Supabase, Vercel

- Internal analytics app to understand usage, payment methods, AI running costs and users at risk of leaving, with an AI-written summary and CSV export. It helped us spot a billing gap that we then fixed.

AI Tomato Disease Detector (final-year project) — Python, PyTorch, ResNet, FastAPI, Next.js

- Trained a convolutional neural network with ResNet transfer learning on the PlantVillage dataset to classify 10 tomato leaf conditions, reaching 99.72% validation accuracy (99.95% training) with a 2.2-second average prediction time.
- Built a Next.js upload interface and FastAPI inference server that return a diagnosis and confidence score and log each prediction to a database.

Chuks Real Estate (client project) — Node.js, Express, SQLite, HTML/CSS/JS

- Property agency website for a Lagos client with listings search, filters and SEO structured data, plus an admin panel the client uses to manage listings, blog, testimonials and enquiries.

Security audits

- Audited a contractor-built Electron app (secrets baked into Docker layers, an auto-updater pointing to an unowned account), performed static malware analysis on release builds, and removed hardcoded API keys from client-side code.

Currently Learning

- System design and scaling real-time AI services
- GPU inference and MLOps (self-hosting models on RunPod)
- Product management, user research and growth
- Cloud certification (AWS) and deeper security practice

What I'm Looking For

Mentorship from engineers and product leaders who are further along, and roles, internships or collaborations where I can contribute, be challenged and keep learning. I am happy to start small, take feedback and put in the work.

Skills

Area	Skills
Engineering	Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Node.js, Express, FastAPI, React, Next.js, HTML/CSS, C#, SQL, Electron, REST APIs & webhooks, Git/GitHub, AI-assisted development (Claude Code)
Cloud & data	PostgreSQL, Supabase, Prisma, Redis/BullMQ, Railway, Vercel, Cloudflare R2, RunPod (GPU), Hostinger
AI products	Real-time video AI, computer vision (CNNs, PyTorch, transfer learning), voice cloning & TTS (ElevenLabs, Fish Audio, MiniMax), Whisper, LLM agents, AI image editing, provider-adapter architecture
Payments & compliance	Flutterwave, Paystack, Squad, Stripe, crypto (USDT), KYC and processor reviews, Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023
Security	Cybersecurity fundamentals, application audits, secrets management, least-privilege database roles, webhook verification
Design	Adobe Photoshop, CorelDRAW, UI/UX design, brand identity, campaign creative
Office & tools	Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint; Slack; Zendesk
Business	Product thinking, teamwork & communication, growth experiments (TikTok Ads), creator partnerships, customer support
Hardware	Computer hardware assembly, maintenance and troubleshooting

Education & Certifications

B.Tech Software Engineering, Second Class Upper Division — Federal University of Technology Owerri (FUTO) · 2021 – April 2026

Final-year project: *Development of a Convolutional Neural Network Model for Tomato Disease Detection* (supervisor: Dr. Iheanyichukwu Aguwa), 99.72% validation accuracy.

Secondary education — Western Boys High School · Class of 2019

Certification	Issuer	Date
Foundational C# with Microsoft	freeCodeCamp × Microsoft	Oct 2023
Introduction to Cybersecurity	Cisco Networking Academy (via Ingressive for Good)	May 2023
Basic Computer Hardware & Maintenance (Certificate of Proficiency)	Givitec UG Germany with Givitec Ltd Nigeria	2019 (1-month programme)